What is biological classification?

Scientists use the word **organism** to describe anything that is alive. In science, we can divide types of organisms into different groups or categories. Each group contains organisms that share certain **features** or **characteristics**. Each group can be broken into smaller groups and then into even smaller groups.

There are millions of types of living things. Scientists use groups to classify living things so that they can be specific and exact in the way they study and talk about things.

☞ **1** Complete the following passage by writing in the missing letters. Hint: It is the same five letters that are missing throughout.

Biological __ __ __ __ __ ification is the process of __ __ __ __ __ ifying all living things according to their shared features or characteristics. Scientists __ __ __ __ __ ify living things so that they can talk specifically and exactly about them.

2 An organism is anything that is alive. List ten examples of organisms.

_____

_____

_____

3 Think of two types of plants that you know about and write descriptions of each. Make sure the two plants are very different from each other. Add a sketch for each one.

Name of plant 1: _____

Description:

_____

_____

_____

_____

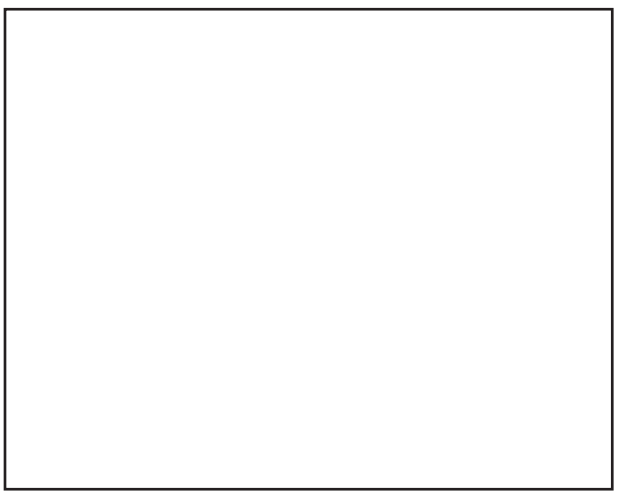
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What is biological classification? CONT'D

Name of plant 2: _____

Description:



4 **a)** In what ways are the plants in Question 3 similar (alike)?

b) In what ways are they different (unalike)?

5 Think of three different animals. In what ways are they similar to one another?

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